

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Employee Salary, Leave & Attendance Management System

A Web-Based HR Management Platform for Startup Teams

Prepared for Client Review & Project Finalisation

Version 1.0

Date: 10 August 2026

1. Document Control

Document Title	Business Requirements Document – Employee Salary, Leave & Attendance Management System
Version	1.0 (Draft for Client Review)
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1.1 Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	10 Aug 2026	Initial draft for client finalisation	[Your Name]

2. Project Overview

2.1 Purpose

The client requires a centralised, web-based system to manage employee attendance, leave requests, and salary calculation for a growing startup team. The system will replace manual spreadsheet-based tracking with a role-based web application that both the management and employees can access from any browser.

2.2 Background

The organisation currently has approximately 10 employees and 1 manager/admin. Attendance, leave approvals, and salary computation are presently handled manually, which is time-consuming and prone to error, especially as the team grows. This application will digitise the entire workflow — from daily attendance marking to monthly payslip generation.

2.3 Objectives

- Provide a single dashboard for the admin to monitor daily workforce presence, absence, and outstation (business travel) status.
- Allow employees to self-serve attendance marking and leave applications, reducing manual coordination.
- Automate salary calculation based on per-day rate, attendance, and approved leaves.
- Maintain a transparent, auditable leave-approval workflow with documented reasons.
- Provide downloadable monthly reports (salary, leave, attendance) for record-keeping and compliance.

2.4 Project Scope

This BRD covers the design and development of a web application with two user roles — Admin and Employee — deployed on a hosted server and delivered to the client for production use. The scope includes the features detailed in Section 4, the business logic in Section 5, and the recommended enhancements in Section 6. Items not explicitly listed (e.g., payroll-tax filing integration, biometric hardware integration) are considered out of scope unless agreed separately.

3. User Roles & Access Levels

The application will support two roles. Access to pages and actions will be controlled by role-based permissions enforced on both the interface and the backend (so a role cannot access another role's pages even by direct URL entry).

Role	Approx. Users	Access Summary
Admin	1 (Manager / Owner)	Full access to all modules — dashboard, salary management, leave approvals, employee creation, and the download centre.
Employee	~10 (expandable)	Access limited to their own dashboard, attendance marking, leave application, leave status, and their own payslip downloads.

3.1 Login & Session Flow

1. User lands on a single Login page and enters their Employee ID / email and password.
2. On successful authentication, the system checks the user's role and redirects to the appropriate dashboard (Admin Dashboard or Employee Dashboard).
3. Invalid credentials show an inline error without revealing whether the ID or password was incorrect (security best practice).
4. Sessions expire after a period of inactivity and require re-login (recommended: 30–60 minutes).

4. Functional Requirements

4.1 Admin Module

The Admin (Manager/Owner) has complete visibility and control over the system. The following pages are included:

A. Admin Dashboard

- Live summary cards for today: total employees present, on leave, absent, and travelling outstation for company work.
- A team status list showing each employee's current status (Present / Half-Day / On Leave / Travelling / Not Marked Yet).
- Quick-glance widgets: pending leave requests awaiting approval, and this month's attendance trend (graph).
- Shortcut links to Salary Management, Leave Management, and Download Centre.

B. Salary Management

- View a list of all employees with their designation and current per-day salary rate.
- Add or update an employee's per-day salary rate, linked to their designation (e.g., Developer, Designer, HR).
- System auto-calculates projected monthly salary using: $(\text{Per-Day Rate} \times \text{Present Days}) + (\text{Half-Day Rate} \times \text{Half-Days}) - (\text{Unpaid Leave Deductions, if applicable})$.
- Maintain a salary revision history (who changed it, old value, new value, date) for audit purposes.

C. Leave Management (Admin)

- View all incoming leave requests with employee name, leave type, dates, reason, and number of days.
- Approve or Decline each request; a Decline action requires the admin to enter a reason, which is shown to the employee.
- Filter/search requests by status (Pending / Approved / Declined), employee, or date range.
- View each employee's remaining leave balance for the year, broken down by leave type, at a glance.
- Configure leave types (Casual, Sick, Paid, Unpaid, Work-From-Home) and set the yearly quota for each.
- Manage the company holiday calendar (add/edit public holidays); these dates are auto-excluded from attendance and leave-day counting across the system.

D. New Employee Creation (Registration)

- Admin-only form to onboard a new employee: name, email, phone, designation, date of joining, per-day salary, and annual leave allotment.
- System auto-generates a unique Employee ID and a temporary password (emailed to the employee, with a forced password reset on first login).
- Admin can edit or deactivate an employee record (e.g., on exit) without deleting historical data.

E. Download Centre (Admin)

- Download a consolidated Excel report per month covering all employees' attendance, leave, and salary.
- Download an individual employee's monthly or yearly report.
- Optional: a simple performance/attendance-score column (e.g., attendance %, punctuality) included in the export.

4.2 Employee Module

Each employee logs in to a personal workspace scoped only to their own data.

A. Employee Dashboard

- Snapshot of remaining leave balance (broken down by leave type, if applicable).
- Mark today's attendance (Present / Half-Day / Work From Outside / On Duty-Travel).
- A mandatory attendance pop-up appears automatically on login each day if today's attendance has not yet been marked (see Section 5.5).
- A quick view of this month's attendance calendar and any upcoming approved leave.

B. Leave Management (Employee)

- Apply for leave by selecting leave type, date range, and entering a reason (mandatory field).
- View the real-time status of every submitted request: Pending, Approved, or Declined (with the admin's reason shown if declined).
- View leave history for the current and past years.

C. Download Centre (Employee)

- Download a monthly salary slip (PDF or Excel) auto-calculated from attendance and approved leave for that month.
- Salary slip shows a clear breakup: days present, half-days, paid leave, unpaid leave/absent days, per-day rate, and net payable amount.

5. Business Rules & System Logic

The rules below were specified by the client and will govern core system behaviour. These are non-negotiable defaults unless the client requests a change during review.

#	Rule	Description
5.1	Leave application cut-off	An employee cannot apply for leave for the current day after 9:00 AM. Leave for the current day must be requested before 9:00 AM; after that, it must be applied for as a future-dated leave or handled by the admin manually.
5.2	Attendance marking cut-off	An employee cannot mark themselves "Present" for a day after that day's End-of-Day (EOD) cut-off time (e.g., 11:59 PM, configurable by admin). Attendance not marked by EOD is auto-flagged as "Not Marked / Absent" pending admin review.
5.3	Half-day marking	An employee can mark a "Half-Day" any time up until EOD of that day.
5.4	Locked historical attendance	Once a day's attendance is saved, the employee cannot edit or change it. Any correction request must go through the admin (a "Request Correction" action notifies the admin for manual override, with a logged reason).
5.5	Mandatory daily attendance prompt	When an employee logs in and has not yet marked attendance for the current day, a pop-up is shown on the dashboard prompting them to mark it immediately. The pop-up reappears on every login until attendance is marked or the day's cut-off passes.
5.6	Leave approval gating	A leave request stays "Pending" until the admin explicitly approves or declines it. Declining always requires a reason, which is visible to the employee.
5.7	Salary computation	Monthly salary = (Per-Day Rate × Days Present) + (Per-Day Rate ÷ 2 × Half-Days) + (Per-Day Rate × Paid Leave Days) – (deductions for unpaid/absent days), based on the designation-linked per-day rate set by the admin.

6. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Pages should load within 2–3 seconds on a standard broadband/mobile connection for up to ~50 concurrent users.
Security	Passwords stored using industry-standard hashing (bcrypt/argon2); all traffic served over HTTPS; role-based access control enforced server-side.
Availability	Target uptime of 99% or higher once deployed on production hosting.
Usability	Clean, mobile-responsive UI usable without training; consistent with the login → role-based dashboard flow.
Data Backup	Automated daily database backups with a defined retention period (e.g., 30 days).
Scalability	Architecture should comfortably support growth from ~10 to 50+ employees without redesign.
Browser Support	Latest versions of Chrome, Edge, Safari, and Firefox on desktop and mobile.

7. Suggested Technology Stack

The stack below is a recommendation and can be adjusted to the developer's or client's preference; it is included to help scope hosting and deployment discussions.

Layer	Recommended Choice
Frontend	React.js (responsive UI, admin/employee dashboards)
Backend	Node.js with Express.js (REST APIs, business logic, authentication)
Database	PostgreSQL or MySQL (relational data — employees, attendance, leave, salary)
Authentication	JWT-based session tokens with role-based middleware
File/Report Generation	Excel export via a library such as ExcelJS; PDF payslips via a PDF generation library
Hosting/Deployment	Cloud VPS or PaaS (e.g., AWS, DigitalOcean, or similar) with HTTPS via a managed SSL certificate
Notifications	Email via SMTP/transactional email service; SMS via a gateway if required